

An aerial photograph showing the coastline of Port Douglas, Queensland, Australia. The turquoise ocean meets a sandy beach, followed by a lush green area with a winding river (the Daintree River) flowing through it. In the background, there are rolling hills and mountains under a blue sky with scattered clouds.

VISITOR GUIDE · TRAVELLING RESPONSIBLY

Port Douglas & Daintree

We can't wait to welcome you to Port Douglas and the Daintree. A few simple things will help you explore this rainforest and reef country safely, and help protect it.

FOUR THINGS TO KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

01 Never approach or feed cassowaries

These large, flightless birds can cause serious injury or death if provoked. Slow down through rainforest habitat and keep well back, never feed one, ever.

02 Don't swim in the Daintree River — treat Mossman Gorge with care

Saltwater crocodiles live in the Daintree River; never swim or wade. At Mossman Gorge, currents are unpredictable and people have died, never jump or dive in.

03 Lean on the ECO Certified Destination status

Port Douglas & Daintree is Australia's first ECO Certified Destination, with 22+ certified operators. This is a genuine point of difference, use it confidently with clients.

04 Acknowledge Eastern Kuku Yalanji and Yirraganydji Country

The Daintree was formally returned to the Eastern Kuku Yalanji in 2021. Include the Mossman Gorge Dreamtime Walk in itineraries where it fits.

PLEASE TAKE EXTRA CARE

Cassowary & crocodile safety. Never feed or approach a cassowary — it can cause serious injury or death. Never swim or wade in the Daintree River, and never jump or dive into Mossman Gorge.

EXPLORING PORT DOUGLAS & DAINTREE RESPONSIBLY

ENCOURAGE

- + Acknowledge Eastern Kuku Yalanji and Yirraganydji Country
- + Choose ECO certified operators wherever possible
- + Book the Mossman Gorge Dreamtime Walk
- + Wear a stinger suit when swimming, Nov–May
- + Check the QPWS conditions report before departure
- + Use reef-safe sunscreen on all reef trips
- + Stay on boardwalks and marked rainforest trails
- + Slow down for cassowaries on rainforest roads
- + Support Indigenous-run cultural experiences

ADVISE AGAINST

- Feeding or approaching cassowaries
- Swimming or wading in the Daintree River
- Jumping or diving into Mossman Gorge
- Touching stinging trees (large serrated heart-shaped leaves)
- Removing coral, shells or rainforest plants
- Swimming at unpatrolled beaches without a stinger suit, Nov–May
- Speeding on rainforest roads, especially at dusk
- Disturbing nesting or roosting wildlife
- Buying souvenirs made from protected species

EASTERN KUKU YALANJI & YIRRAGANYDJI CULTURAL RESPECT

Mossman Gorge and the wider Daintree are profoundly significant to the Eastern Kuku Yalanji. The Mossman Gorge Centre has maintained 80–90% Indigenous employment since 2012, we'd encourage you to start your visit there.